✓ HAVING FULL RIGHTS TO WORK IN THE UK · NO VISA SPONSORSHIP REQUIRED

ARCHANA KANNAN

AI-Powered Software Quality Engineer

Senior QA Automation Engineer / SDET

PHONE +44 75030 75705
EMAIL archana-kannan@outlook.com
LINKEDIN linkedin.com/in/archana-kannan-uk
GITHUB github.com/archana-kannan
LOCATION Birmingham, United Kingdom

TypeScript · JavaScript · Playwright · WebdriverIO · Cypress · Web / API / Mobile · Agentic AI · Vue.js · Azure DevOps

PROFILE

AI-Powered Software Quality Engineer with **16+ years** across software testing, automation and end-to-end quality engineering, including **8+ years of hands-on automation** with Playwright (TypeScript/Node.js), WebdriverIO (JavaScript) and Cypress across web UI, REST API, integration and E2E testing. Evolving traditional test automation into **AI-powered quality engineering** by building GitHub Copilot and Claude agents that turn API specifications into Playwright tests. A developer-in-test who diagnoses and fixes Vue.js defects directly, architects frameworks from scratch, and integrates quality gates into Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- Led a **Playwright/TypeScript proof of concept** that secured management approval to migrate from Serenity BDD, then trained the QA team on the new framework.
- **Architected a reusable Playwright framework from scratch** (TypeScript/Node.js) covering web UI, REST API, integration and E2E testing.
- Built **agentic AI workflows** (GitHub Copilot & Claude) that consume OpenAPI specifications and generate Playwright API tests.
- Fixes application defects directly in **Vue.js**, reducing QA-to-development hand-offs and accelerating defect resolution.
- Developed a reusable **Playwright desktop automation package** and a custom **VS Code extension** for Azure DevOps PR reviews.
- Received the **Entrepreneurial Award** at Broadridge Analytics Solutions for innovative thinking and technical leadership.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI Quality Engineering	GitHub Copilot, Claude, Agentic AI, AI test-generation agents, prompt-driven automation, OpenAPI-driven test authoring, AI-assisted PR review
Test Automation	Playwright (TypeScript/Node.js), WebdriverIO (JavaScript), Cypress, Cucumber/Gherkin, Page Object Model
Development & Fixing	Vue.js front-end debugging and bug fixes, root-cause analysis, fix validation
API & Services	Playwright API, Postman (REST/JSON), SoapUI (SOAP/XML), OpenAPI/Swagger
Testing Types	UI, API, E2E, Integration, Regression, Smoke, Cross-Browser, Desktop, System/SIT, Mobile (Android/iOS)
CI/CD & Source Control	Azure DevOps Pipelines, Azure Services, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Git, GitHub, GitLab, PR/MR reviews
Languages & Build	TypeScript, JavaScript, Node.js, NPM
Tools & Delivery	VS Code, Visual Studio, Jira, X-Ray, HP ALM, Confluence, Agile/Scrum, BDD, Waterfall, SDLC/STLC

WORK EXPERIENCE

BROADRIDGE ANALYTICS SOLUTIONS

Client: Broadridge Fund Communications **Role:** **SDET-AI Software Quality Engineer** **Dates:** Nov 2021 - Present

Location: Birmingham / Bristol, UK **Business:** Finance / Asset Management

Project: Automation quality engineering for a financial reporting platform: led the move from Serenity BDD to a Playwright/TypeScript framework built from scratch, created GitHub Copilot & Claude agents that generate API tests from OpenAPI specs, fixed Vue.js defects, integrated smoke/regression suites into Azure DevOps pipelines with results on custom dashboards, and built a desktop automation package and a VS Code PR-review extension.

TATA CONSULTANCY SERVICES (TCS)

Client: Lloyds Banking Group | **Role:** **QA Automation Engineer** | **Dates:** Oct 2018 - Jun 2020

Location: Bristol, UK | **Business:** Banking

Project: Built and maintained WebdriverIO automation (JavaScript, Cucumber, Page Object Model) for functional and API regression across maintenance releases, with source control, code reviews and merge requests in GitLab.

TATA CONSULTANCY SERVICES (TCS)

Client: Staples-Quill & AXA | **Role:** **QA Automation Engineer** | **Dates:** Aug 2010 - Sep 2018

Location: Chennai, India | **Business:** Retail E-Commerce, Insurance

Project: Automated B2B/B2C e-commerce journeys with Selenium WebDriver, managed in GitHub, led functional, integration and mobile testing, owned test planning and release readiness, and tested motor-insurance new business, renewals and claims.

COGNIZANT TECHNOLOGY SOLUTIONS

Client: ACES Insurance, USA | **Role:** **QA Analyst** | **Dates:** May 2007 - Aug 2010

Location: Chennai, India | **Business:** Dental Insurance

Project: Functional testing of policy and claims workflows for a US dental-insurance application, covering test design, execution, defect management and reporting.

KEY RESPONSIBILITIES, CONTRIBUTIONS & KNOWLEDGE

AI-Powered Quality Engineering

- Turn product specifications and API contracts into automated tests using AI agents, removing repetitive hand-authoring.
- Move teams from traditional scripted automation to AI-assisted, specification-driven workflows without losing deterministic checks.
- Build reusable agent patterns and engineering tools that speed up test creation and code review.

Automation Strategy & Architecture

- Design automation frameworks from the ground up with clear standards, reusable components and stable, low-maintenance tests.
- Make the case for modernisation through proofs of concept, then lead migrations without losing existing coverage.
- Cover the full stack: web UI, APIs, integration, end-to-end, desktop and mobile.

Developer-in-Test

- Trace failures into front-end application code, fix them directly and prove the fix with targeted regression.
- Shorten the path from defect to resolution by reducing hand-offs between QA and development.
- Own defects end to end: discovery, root-cause analysis, triage and closure.

Continuous Quality & Delivery

- Build quality gates into deployment pipelines so every release is checked automatically.
- Give stakeholders clear, real-time visibility of test outcomes and release readiness.
- Keep codebases healthy through peer reviews and disciplined branching and merge practices.

Test Leadership

- Plan, estimate and lead testing for banking, insurance, finance and e-commerce programmes.
- Balance risk, coverage and timelines to deliver confident releases in Agile and Waterfall settings.

Collaboration & Mentoring

- Work closely with Product Owners, SMEs and developers from refinement through to demo and release.
- Coach colleagues on modern automation and AI adoption, and share knowledge through clear documentation.

DOMAIN EXPERTISE

Finance & Asset Management
Financial reporting and fund communications platforms

Banking
Retail banking applications and regression across releases

Insurance (General, Motor & Dental)
Policy, new business, renewals and claims workflows

Retail E-Commerce (B2B & B2C)
End-to-end online ordering and customer journeys

EDUCATION

MBA
Anna University, Chennai

B.Sc. Mathematics
University of Madras, Chennai

RECOGNITION

- **Entrepreneurial Award** - Broadridge Analytics Solutions, for innovative thinking and technical leadership

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